The vision and requirements

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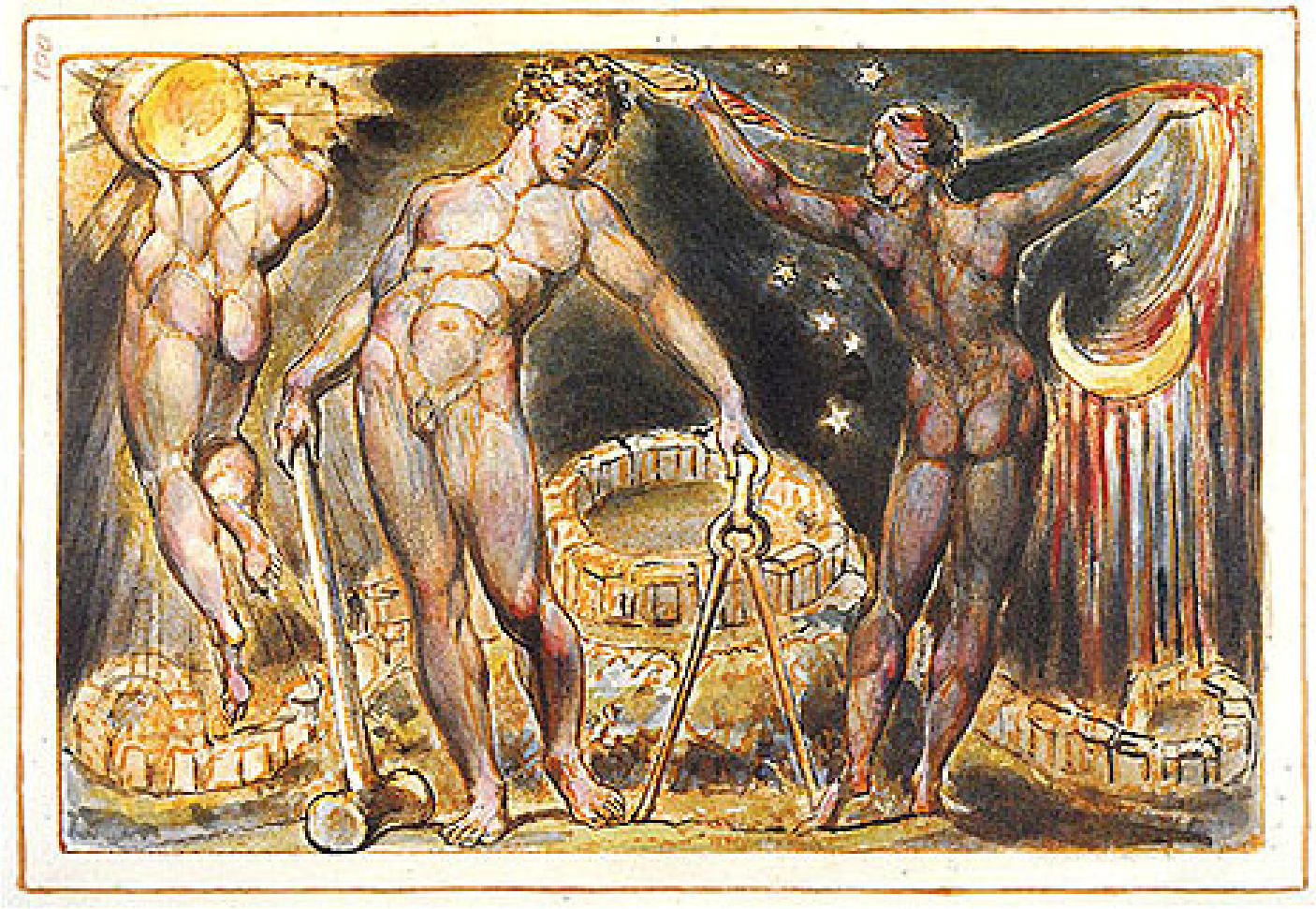

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What is CESSDA?

- CESSDA is an acronym for the “Council of European Social Science Data Archives.”
- CESSDA has provided networked infrastructural services for the social sciences for the past 30 years through the acquisition, support and supply of data for the European Social Science and Humanities research community.
- Collectively the constituent CESSDA member organisations serve some 200,000 SSH researchers within the ERA each year, providing access to and delivering some 70,000+ data collections per annum and acquiring a further 3,500 data collections each year. In addition, the CESSDA organisations provide access gateways to important SSH data materials and EU investments such as the European Social Survey, the Eurobarometers, the International Social Survey Programme and the European Values Surveys.

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General Aims of the CESSDA Research Infrastructure PPP

• The focus of this project will be a major upgrade of the CESSDA RI to ensure that European Social Science and Humanities (SSH) researchers have access to, and gain support for, data resources they require to conduct research of the highest quality, irrespective of the location of either researcher or data within the European Research Area (ERA).

• The project will also improve the CESSDA RI so that member organisations are able to transcend the limitations of their national resources through the creation of a common platform, mission and stronger form of integration in which expertise is genuinely pooled, shared and applied in a co-ordinated pan-European experience.

• This project will facilitate the delivery of a fully-integrated data archive infrastructure for the SSH, allowing seamless, permanent access to as many data holdings across Europe as possible.

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Work package 3 – the core of the PPP

Objective 1 *- To develop a framework capable of sustaining a SSH research infrastructure of the highest quality, through the identification, examination, proposal and resolution of strategic, financial, governance and legal issues regarding the activities and functions of CESSDA, its members and administrative body in order to prepare for and accommodate a major upgrade of the RI.*

Objective 2 *- To secure financial commitment from stakeholders for the sustained support and development of the CESSDA RI.*

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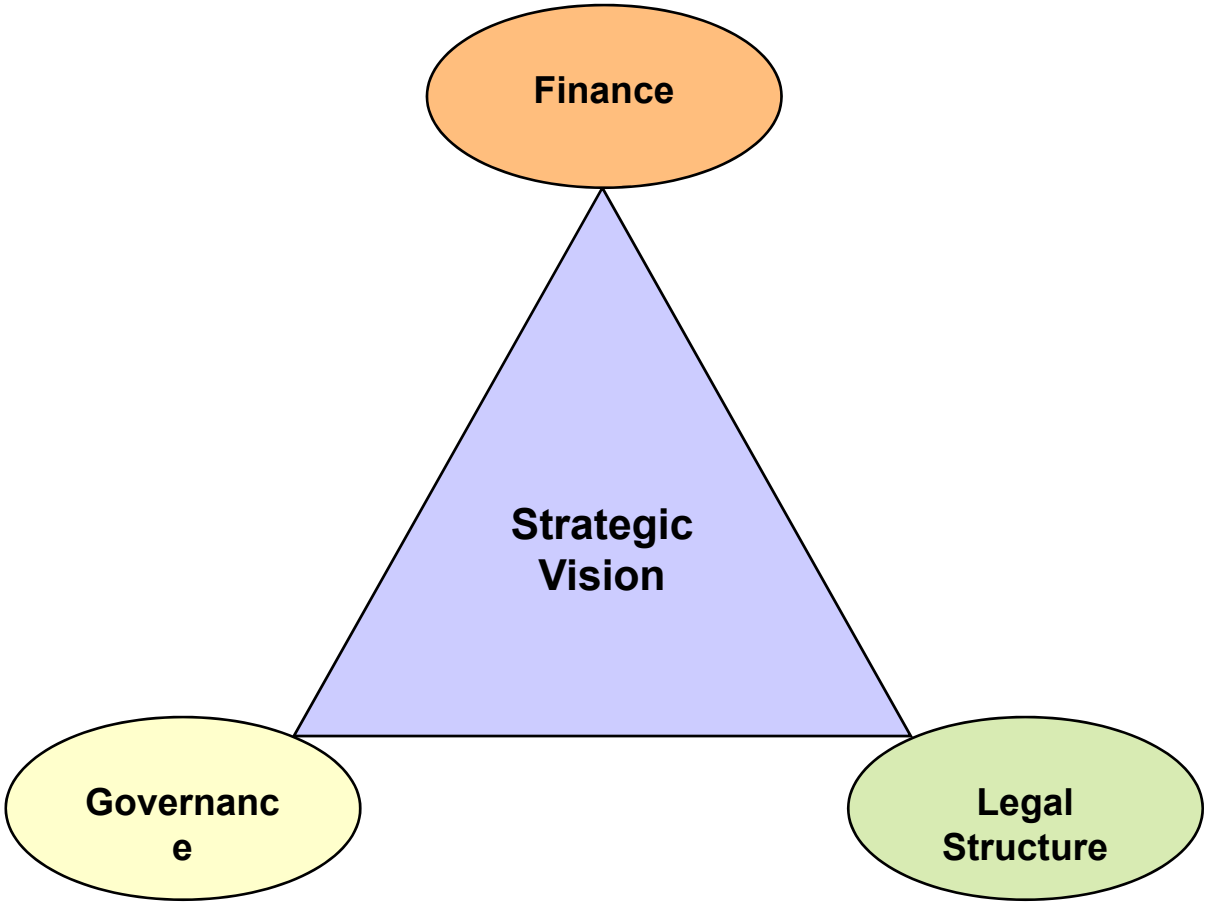
The CESSDA PPP triangle